

programs with complex rules and conditions. Many people don't even know these programs exist, and there is no guarantee the programs won't change. Some companies look to capitalize on people's ignorance by offering a one-size-fits-all answer to refinance. While refinancing is good for some, it can cost others tens of thousands of dollars. Worse yet, once that decision is made, there is usually no turning back.

Travis Hornsby, founder of *Student Loan Planner*, spoke on the *ChooseFI* podcast about the options available to those burdened by student loans. Hornsby stated that his company saves their average client \$60,000 because people make so many mistakes when paying back their student loans. The key point that Hornsby emphasizes is, "There's hope for people [with student loan debt]. That person can achieve FI, and maybe they didn't think they could before."

Hornsby shared two options for dealing with student loans. You can pay your loans off as quickly as possible, or you can seek loan forgiveness. Many of the rules he discussed are subject to legislative changes, and the information may be time sensitive, so we'll give a general overview. *Before implementing any strategy, do your own research to be sure that none of the rules have changed.*